

Second Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Secunda Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: charity embodied in the banquet of God

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Factus est Dominus protector meus</i> (Ps. 17)	Rescue into breadth	St. Ambrose on the Psalms; Cassiodorus on Psalm 17	The Lord does not merely defend; he brings the soul into the wide place of divine charity.
Collect	Fear and love of the holy Name	Holy fear and stable love	St. Bernard on the Name of Jesus; St. Catherine of Siena on holy fear	The prayer joins reverence and intimacy: fear keeps love from presumption, love keeps fear from servility.
Epistle	1 John 3:13-18	Passing from death to life by loving the brethren	St. Augustine, Homilies on 1 John; St. John Chrysostom on almsgiving	Charity must leave the tongue and enter work and truth.
Gospel	Luke 14:16-24	The great supper	St. Gregory the Great, Gospel homilies; St. Bede on Luke	Excuses reveal disordered loves; the poor and broken reveal the gratuitous wideness of the invitation.
Offertory	<i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam</i> (Ps. 6)	Conversion before communion	Desert Fathers on compunction	The banquet is entered by being turned around, not by self-justification.
Communion	<i>Cantabo Domino, qui bona tribuit mihi</i> (Ps. 12)	Thanksgiving for benefits	St. Ignatius of Loyola, gratitude as root of service	The communicant sings because the supper is already gift before it is task.
Postcommunion	<i>Sumptis muneribus sacris</i>	Growth of salvation	St. Augustine on repeated sacramental healing; St. Thomas on Eucharistic increase	Frequent reception of the mystery is ordered to an increasing effect of salvation in the soul.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Luke 14 presents a man making a great supper, the invited guests refusing through excuses, and the poor and wounded being brought in.
Allegorical	The supper signifies the Kingdom and the Eucharistic banquet of the Church, where Israel's call opens into the gathering of the nations and the spiritually poor.
Moral	The hearer must examine respectable attachments that make him refuse grace, then prove charity in deed and truth as 1 John commands.
Anagogical	The earthly invitation anticipates the eternal wedding feast, where every excuse will be exposed and every healed poverty will become joy.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Banquet	Luke's great supper is the governing symbol, and the Communion turns that parable toward Eucharistic thanksgiving. Biblically, the banquet gathers Sinai covenant meals, Wisdom's table, prophetic feasts on the mountain, Christ's table fellowship, and the marriage supper of the Lamb. Patristic readers see in it the Church's Eucharistic and eschatological table. The symbol reveals grace as invitation before achievement: God prepares, summons, feeds, and only then demands that charity become deed and truth.
Excuse	Field, oxen, and marriage are lawful goods, which makes the symbol sharper. The Fathers do not read the excuses as crude vice only, but as ordered goods swollen into rival absolutes. An excuse is a good thing used to avoid the highest good. The Church groups this with 1 John to expose theoretical charity: the same heart that refuses the supper will also close itself to the needy brother.
Poverty	The poor, maimed, blind, and lame reveal who can enter the house. Poverty here is not romanticized misery; it is receptive need. The patristic tradition sees in these guests sinners, Gentiles, the humble, and those who know they cannot claim precedence. The symbol instructs communicants to come to Mass as invited beggars, not as socially established guests doing God a courtesy.
Bread and Table	The table is both kingdom sign and altar sign. It gathers eating, communion, fellowship, sacrifice, and judgment. Scripture repeatedly shows that meals disclose belonging: Israel eats manna, sinners eat with Christ, Emmaus recognizes him in the breaking of bread. The symbol presses the moral question of the Epistle: if one table makes us brethren, how can a closed heart remain closed after Communion?
Wideness	The Introit's <i>latitudo</i> becomes the house with room still available. God rescues into breadth, while sin contracts the soul into private management of property, work, and domestic life. The Church's instruction is not contempt for ordinary duties, but liberation from cramped loves. The wide house of grace makes the soul wide enough for mercy.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

The Church groups rescue, holy fear, brotherly charity, the great supper, conversion, and thanksgiving in order to interpret the Eucharistic invitation. Patristic exegesis reads Luke's banquet not as a pleasant image of religion, but as the crisis of grace: the invited refuse because their loves are disordered, while the

poor enter because they have nothing with which to bargain. First John then supplies the test of whether the invitation has been accepted: love must become deed and truth.

Thread	Synthesis
Introit: Psalm 17	Ambrose and Cassiodorus read rescue from enemies as the soul being brought out of constriction into divine spaciousness. This prepares the Gospel: the banquet hall is wide, but the soul narrowed by attachment cannot enter freely.
Collect: fear and love of the Name	Bernard's devotion to the holy Name and the monastic tradition join reverence with affection. The Collect guards the banquet from two errors: servile fear that stays away and presumption that comes without conversion.
Epistle: 1 John 3	Augustine reads passing from death to life as the passage into charity; hatred is a death still present in the religious man. The Church places this before Luke so that the hearer cannot treat the supper as private consolation while neglecting the brother.
Gospel: Luke 14	Gregory the Great reads the excuses as lawful earthly goods made obstacles by disordered love. Bede sees the poor, maimed, blind, and lame as those who know their need and can be healed by grace.
Offertory: Psalm 6	Patristic penitential reading hears a soul asking to be turned and delivered. After the refused banquet, the Offertory gives the correct response: not excuse, but conversion.
Communion and Postcommunion	Thanksgiving for benefits completes the movement, and the Postcommunion asks that repeated participation increase salvation's effect. The communicant sings not because he has earned the supper, but because he has been rescued, invited, converted, and fed.

Thread	Synthesis
Invitation and charity	Luke reveals the open table; 1 John reveals the necessary fruit. The faithful are taught that Eucharistic communion and practical mercy cannot be separated.
Goods and excuses	Land, oxen, and marriage are not condemned as evil. Gregory's line of interpretation exposes how ordinary goods become refusals when they outrank the call of God.
Poverty and readiness	The poor enter because need has made them receptive. The Church's grouping instructs the faithful to approach Mass as beggars, not as patrons accepting an honor.
Conversion, song, and increase	The Offertory asks deliverance before Communion sings gratitude; the Postcommunion asks that the mystery's effect grow by being frequented. Liturgically, the Church trains the hearer to move from compunction to thanksgiving and deepening conversion.
Church's instruction	The faithful are being told: God has widened the place of salvation, but only charity proves that one has truly entered the supper. Every respectable excuse must be judged by love in deed and truth.

Exegetical Notes

- Luke 14 is spoken at table. Christ turns an ordinary meal into an image of the Kingdom and of Eucharistic readiness.
- The excuses are not gross sins. Land, oxen, and marriage are legitimate goods made ultimate.
- The servant's mission widens in stages: invited guests, city streets, then roads and hedges. Grace presses outward.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. Augustine	“Love, and do what thou wilt.” Homily on 1 John	Explain carefully: Augustine means rightly ordered charity fulfills action, not that impulse replaces obedience.
St. Gregory the Great	The poor brought to supper show those whom the proud overlook.	Use Gregory to expose respectable refusals and to honor the hidden guests of God.
St. John Chrysostom	Almsgiving is a concrete test of love for Christ.	Tie the Epistle’s “deed and truth” to parish works of mercy.
St. Benedict	Prefer nothing to the love of Christ.	The good things named in the excuses must remain below the supreme good.

Thread	Synthesis
Banquet and almsgiving	The Epistle tests the Gospel. One cannot accept the invitation to the great supper while closing the heart to a needy brother.
Excuses and attachments	Field, oxen, and marriage are goods; they become refusals when treated as ultimate. This is a classic patristic reading of ordered love.
Fear and love	The Collect prevents two errors: servile terror that avoids the table, and casual presumption that ignores the summons.
Church and mission	The servant who announces supper is an image of apostolic preaching: the Church compels by truth, beauty, mercy, and urgency.
Prayer focus	Identify the respectable excuse that keeps charity theoretical, then answer the invitation through one concrete act of mercy.

Preaching Applications

- Name modern excuses without contempt: busyness, family logistics, work, property, reputation, and curated comfort.
- Press the Eucharistic question: do I come to the Lord’s table while refusing the brother Christ has seated near me?
- Offer one concrete practice: before Sunday Mass, choose one act of hidden charity for someone who cannot repay it.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Secunda post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Augustine on 1 John; Gregory the Great on Luke 14; Bede on the Gospel of Luke.

Full Patristic and Sainly Texts

- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “Once for all, then, a short precept is given you: Love, and do what you will.”
- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “Let charity be there, and she fearlessly forgives, not being straitened.”